LANGUAGE & SOCIETY PROJECT

Transcript Analysis Worksheet

Qualitative analysis of political news discourse

Guidelines: Five features to look for in every event

Feature	What to look for	Illustrative example	Questions to answer
1. Naming	What are people, groups, actions, or events called?	"Students", "protesters", "agitators"; "irregularity", "scam", "controversy".	What exact label is used? Who or what does it refer to? Who uses it? What alternative label could have been used?
2. Presupposition	What is treated as already true or taken for granted?	"Why are students creating chaos again?" may presuppose earlier disruption.	What does the wording assume? Is that assumption supported, disputed, or left unexamined? Does it appear in a question or words such as "again", "still", or "finally"?
3. Agency	Who is shown doing something? Who is acted upon? Who disappears?	"Police injured protesters" vs. "Protesters were injured."	Who is the actor? Who experiences the action? Is responsibility named, backgrounded, or omitted?
4. Antagonisation	Who is positioned against whom?	"Ordinary citizens" vs. "political troublemakers".	Which groups are contrasted? Is one presented as more legitimate, moral, patriotic, dangerous, or disloyal? Is an "us vs. them" division implied?
5. Intensification / softening	What is exaggerated, minimised, softened, or euphemised?	"Violent mob" vs. "peaceful demonstrators"; "incident" instead of a direct description.	Which words heighten emotion or seriousness? Which minimise it? Are metaphors, dramatic adjectives, hedges, or euphemisms used? Does the wording match the evidence?

Reminder: A label or implication is not automatically false or manipulative. Examine the surrounding context and evidence.

Event1. Ram Mandir donation controversy

Focus: How is the controversy framed—as financial accountability, religious sentiment, political motivation, or something else? Be precise about the specific allegation or episode covered. **Outlet:** _____
Date: _____

Video title: _____

Timestamp(s): _____ **Analyst:** _____

Language: _____

Event-specific questions

1. What terms are used: "scam", "alleged irregularity", "corruption", "political controversy", or something else?
2. How are the temple, trust, donors, and people making allegations described?
3. Is the issue framed as financial accountability, an attack on Hindu faith, a political dispute, or a matter of public trust?
4. Are questions about donations presented as legitimate scrutiny or as an attempt to malign the temple or its supporters?
5. Are allegations attributed to specific people and supported with evidence, or presented as established facts?
6. How are denials and counterarguments represented: explained, dismissed, challenged, or omitted?
7. Does the presenter distinguish criticism of the trust or its financial practices from criticism of the temple or religion itself?
8. Who is portrayed as protecting donors' interests, and who as exploiting religious sentiment?

Apply the five shared features

Feature	Exact wording + timestamp	What it does in context
Naming		
Presupposition		
Agency		
Antagonisation		
Intensification / softening		

Short summary

What interpretation of the event does this video encourage?

Whose perspective is foregrounded, challenged, or missing?

What evidence supports your interpretation? What complicates it?

Event2. Students' protest regarding NEET paper leak

Focus: How does coverage construct the legitimacy of student protest and responsibility for the underlying problem? **Outlet:** _____ **Date:** _____

Video title: _____

Timestamp(s): _____ **Analyst:** _____

Language: _____

Event-specific questions

1. Are participants called "students", "candidates", "protesters", "agitators", "mobs", or "political pawns"?
2. Are their stated demands explained, summarised, mocked, questioned, or left out?
3. Does the presenter focus on the original grievance, disruption, political affiliations, or public inconvenience?
4. Who is represented as responsible: examination authorities, government, students, political parties, or others?
5. Are questions framed around whether students have legitimate grievances, or why they are causing disruption?
6. Are claims of violence, disorder, or political manipulation attributed to sources and substantiated?
7. How are police and government actions described compared with protesters' actions? Are similar actions evaluated differently?
8. Are students allowed to explain their demands in their own words, or does the presenter mainly speak for them?
9. Does the outlet's framing differ between coverage of the NEET paper-leak issue before the protest and coverage once students begin protesting?

Apply the five shared features

Feature	Exact wording + timestamp	What it does in context
Naming		
Presupposition		
Agency		
Antagonisation		
Intensification / softening		

Short summary

What interpretation of the event does this video encourage?

Whose perspective is foregrounded, challenged, or missing?

What evidence supports your interpretation? What complicates it?

Common form: Blank excerpt record

Copy or print this page whenever you find a passage worth analysing. Keep the exact wording and enough context to interpret it. **Outlet:** _____ **Date:** _____

Video title: _____

Timestamp(s): _____ **Analyst:** _____

Language: _____

Exact transcript excerpt

Feature(s): ☐ Naming ☐ Presupposition ☐ Agency ☐ Antagonisation ☐ Intensification / softening

Who is speaking? Is this the outlet's wording or a quotation?

What does the wording imply, foreground, soften, or leave unstated?

What context or evidence supports or complicates this interpretation?

How does another outlet describe the same event or actor?

My interpretation, with reasons

Common form: End-of-event summary

The main way this outlet framed the event was:

The strongest linguistic evidence was (quote + timestamp):

The shared feature(s) most clearly illustrated were:

An alternative interpretation of the same evidence is:

What I cannot conclude from this transcript alone:

Research reminder: interpret wording in context, distinguish allegations from established facts, and support claims with exact excerpts. Mixed or contradictory evidence is worth recording.